

Cloud storage services

Cloud Storage services are one of the most important and widely talked about offshoots of the cloud computing rise. These services offer a large amount of storage space to back up files online. Some also allow you to sync your backed up data across devices, but essentially, there's just glorified net-based folders to store your stuff. Here's a short list of some of the better ones:

JustCloud: JustCloud is probably the leader in the pack of cloud storage services. It has syncing ability across devices and you can access backed up data on the go. It offers an unlimited data storage, for a fee of course. The trial version has little capacity which is quite a letdown. JustCloud has an industry standard security system in place for protection and there is geo redundant storage option for ensuring durability. Other features include file versioning, laptop tracker and customisable back up automation.



Crash plan: Crash plan is a good option for beginners. There is a simple desktop application that allows you to backup files on the service's remote server or elsewhere (including your cousin or friend's place, office, and an external hard disk). The service does not have a syncing option and transfer speeds are pretty low. Storage rent is affordable and there is automatic backup option. Restoring is fairly simple like most of the other things to do and this makes Crash plan a great option for novice users.

Carbonite: Carbonite is a relatively old cloud backup service. It has been around for quite some years and offers a stable solution for causal customers. There is an automatic backup and scheduling feature and the user interface is fairly intuitive. Carbonite is pretty much a basic backup tool which is kind of perfect for first time users. You can manually select files to backup or choose the automatic option. A backup tab shows you the progress. Carbonite home also has a mobile app. The service comes in several packages like basic, HomePlus and HomePremier. Carbonite Home lacks syncing and limited bandwidth makes it slow, but still it is an ideal option for a home user with basic backup needs.

LiveDrive: LiveDrive offers unlimited storage at a competitive price. It doesn't limit the bandwidth at its end which allows you to access really fast backup speeds. Besides the general backup and restore client features, LiveDrive has a neat sync ability and manages file conflicts admirably. The combination of all of the above with military grade encryption technology